

Gaming consoles

Playing computer games is a popular pastime for many people. Many young people learn the basics of coding by creating their own games.

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Playing games

Computer gaming is often seen as a solitary pursuit, but in fact playing online multiplayer games can be a very sociable experience. Some of the earliest games, including Pong and Atari's Space Race, were for two players playing on the same computer. These days, many games offer players the ability to play each other regardless of where they are on Earth, through online play. This means that friends can catch up as they play a game together, or players can find completely new people to play with. People often use headsets or onscreen text messages to communicate with each other.

▷ Open to all

Computer games let people of different ages and abilities connect and have fun together. They can also allow people with physical disabilities to compete in a way they aren't able to in real-world sports.

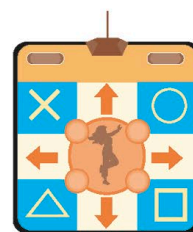


Game controllers

It's possible to play many games using a normal computer keyboard, but this isn't always easy, particularly with fast-paced action games. There are a number of dedicated game controllers available, the most familiar being the joystick (originally designed as a control for aeroplanes). Many controllers even incorporate haptic feedback where the controller vibrates or resists movement, to add to the gaming experience.



Player's body movement



Dance pad

▷ Unusual controllers

Some controllers move away from traditional buttons and joysticks. Many are designed to look like something in the game – so a steering-wheel controller for a driving game or a guitar controller for a music-rhythm game. Others, such as Microsoft's Kinect camera or dance mats, let players control a game by body movements.



Guitar controller



Steering-wheel controller